

IKS – INDIAN KNOWLEDGE SYSTEMS

UNIT 2 - YOGA BASIC PRACTICES AND PHILOSOPHY

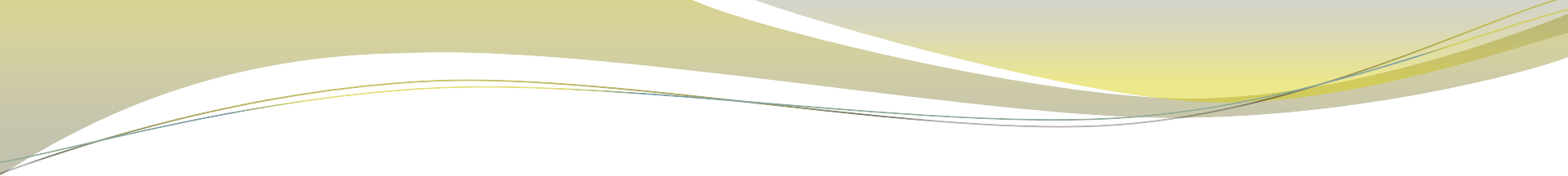
SCOPE OF STUDY

UNIT 2.1

1. Maharshi Patanjali
2. Swami Satyananada Sarawati
3. B.K.S. Iyengar
4. Swami Kuvalayananda
5. Shri Yogendra

UNIT 2.2

- 1. Body loosening exercises**
- 2. Importance of breath**
- 3. Developing concentration**
- 4. Yoga for mind – body wellness**



BODY LOOSENING EXERCISES

LECTURE BY: DR. ALKA M. BHIVANDKAR
19th, 20th August 2025

SHANTI PRAYER

Krishna Yajurveda Taittiriya Upanishad (2.2.2)

ॐ सहनाववतु
सह नौ भुनक्तु
सह वीर्यं करवाव है
तेजस्वि नावधीतमस्तु मा विद्विषाव है
ॐ शान्तिः शान्तिः शान्तिः

Om Saha nāvavatu
Saha nau bhunaktu
Saha vīryam karavāvahai
Tejasvi nāvadhītamastu
Mā vidviṣāvahai
Om Shāntiḥ, Shāntiḥ, Shāntiḥ

Om, May we all (Teacher and student) be protected
May we all be nourished
May we work together with great energy
May our intellect be sharpened (may our study be effective) ; Let there be no Animosity amongst us
Om, peace, peace, peace

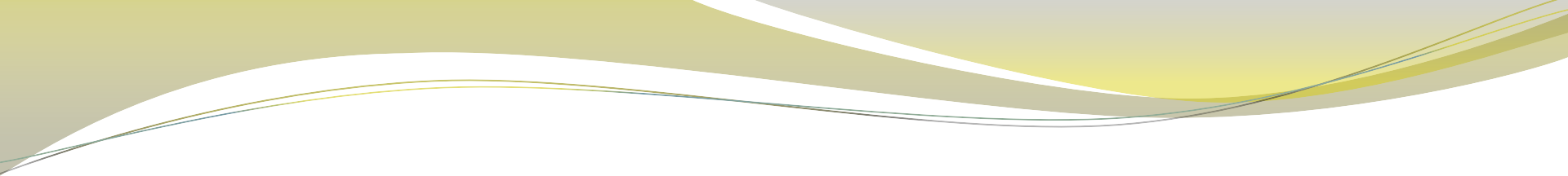
INTRODUCTION

- **Body Loosening exercises** are also called as **Sukshma Vyayamas**
- It is the oldest element in Yoga which was propagated, designed and developed initially by
- **Maharishi Karthikeyaji Maharaj** of the Himalaya
- Maharishi taught these practices to **Swami Dhirendra Brahmachari** (1924 – 1974) who in turn propagated it across the modern world



BENEFITS OF BODY LOOSENING EXERCISES

- The movements from these exercises sequentially work out all joints of the body
- A good way to warm up before yoga practice
- These are ways to protect the joints
- To keep them moving mindfully and
- changing postures from time to time
- These exercises improve circulation,
- Remove stiffness and tension,
- Relax the nervous system
- have a strong purifying effect on body energy
- They enable one to stay healthy and positive

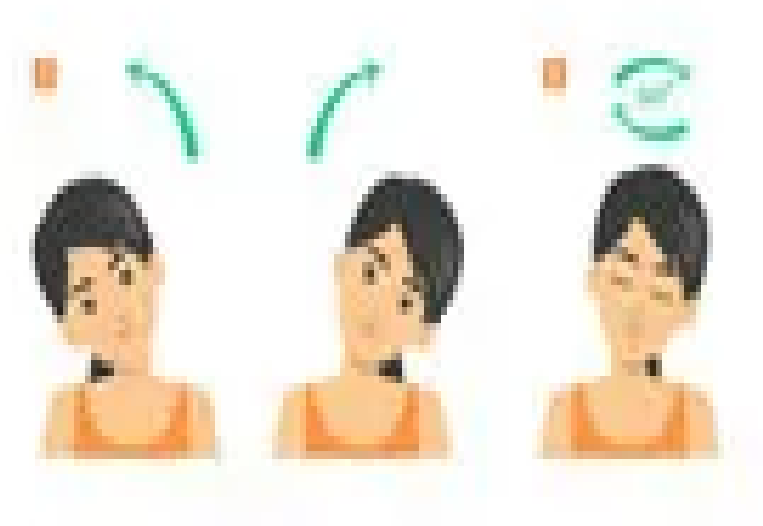
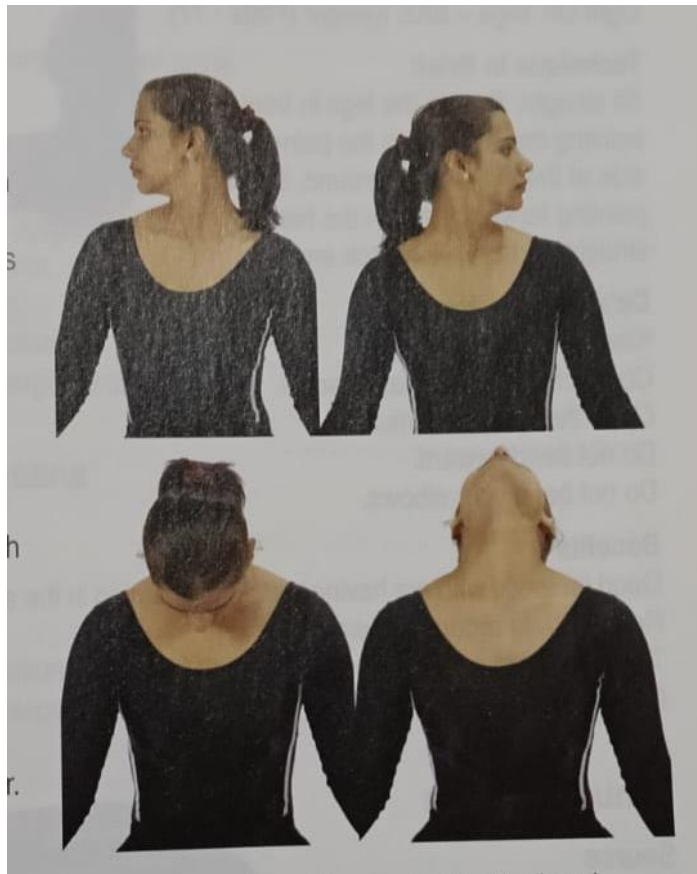


BODY LOOSENING PRACTICES

BODY LOOSENING PRACTICES

JOINTS / PART OF BODY	SUKSHMA VYAYAMA
Neck	Greeva Shakti Vikasaka
Shoulders	Bhuja Shakti Vikasaka
Elbows	Kehuni Shakti Vikasaka
Wrists	Manibandha Shakti Vikasaka
Waist/Trunk	Kati Shakti Vikasaka
Hip joint	Jangha Shakti Vikasaka
Knees	Jaanu Shakti Vikasaka
Ankles	Goolfha Shakti Vikasaka
Toes	Pada anguli Shakti Vikasaka

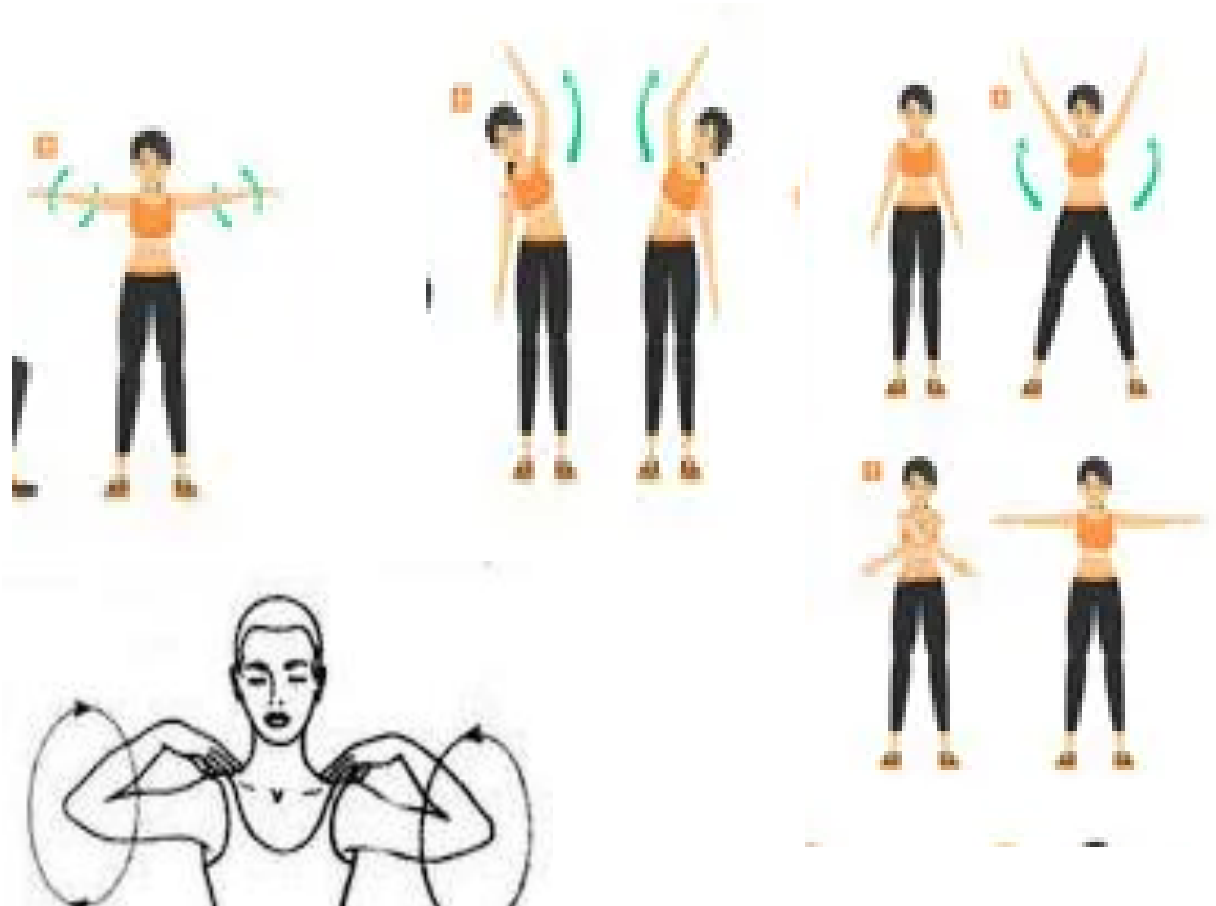
GREEVA SHAKTI VIKASAKA FOR NECK JOINTS



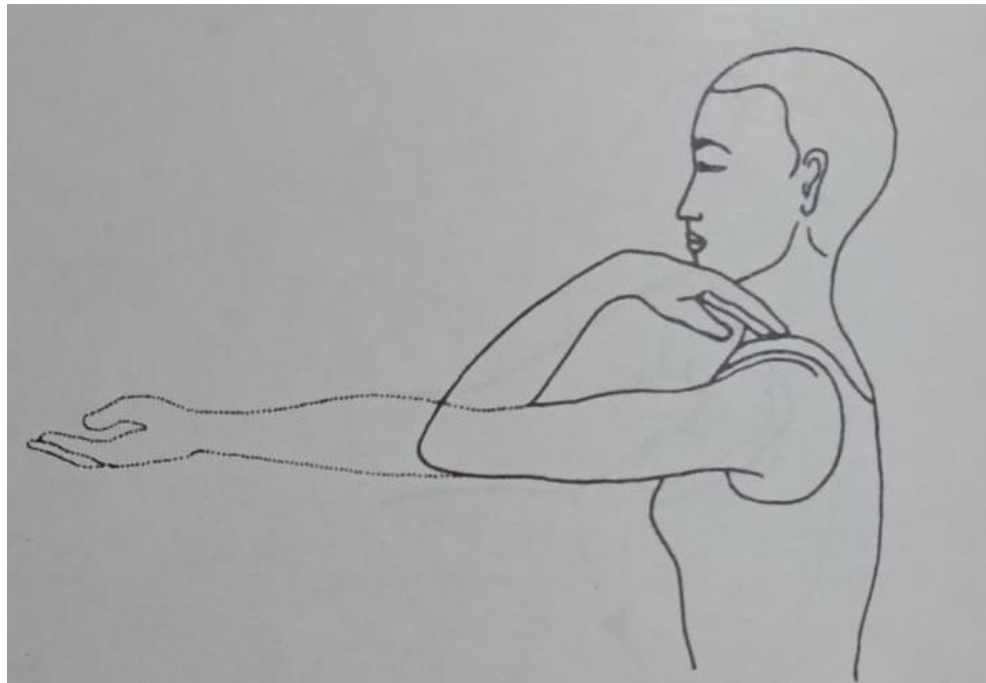
BHUJA SHAKTI VIKASAKA FOR SHOULDERS

Yoga Sequence Builder

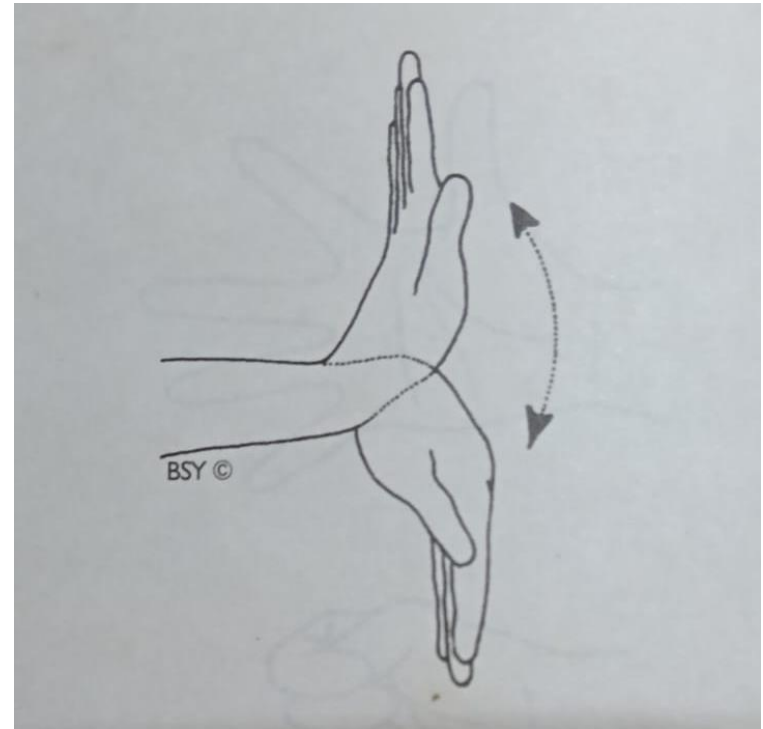
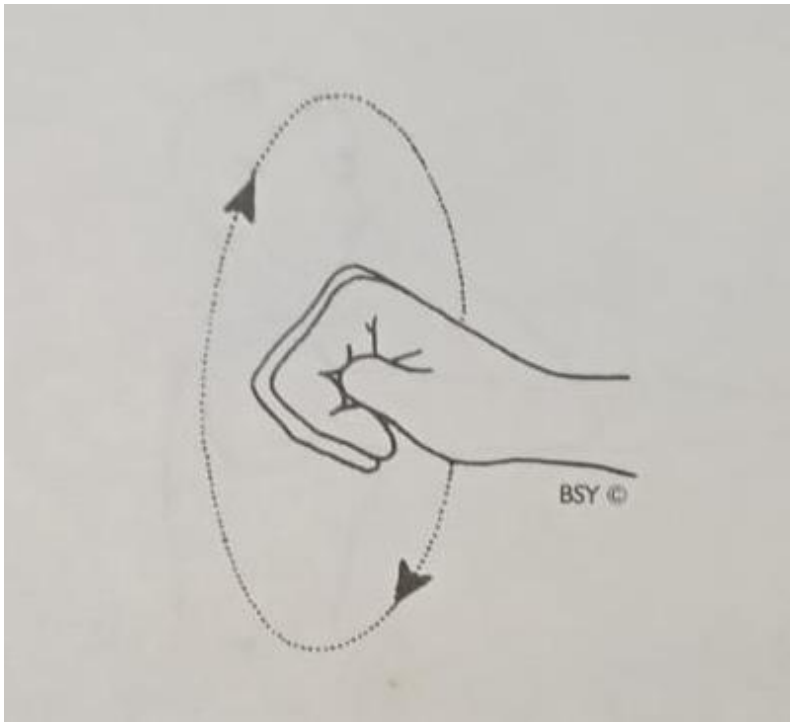
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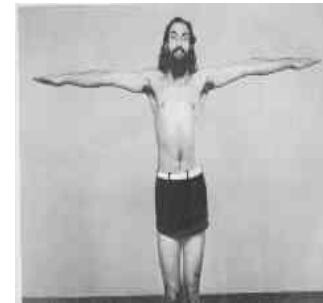
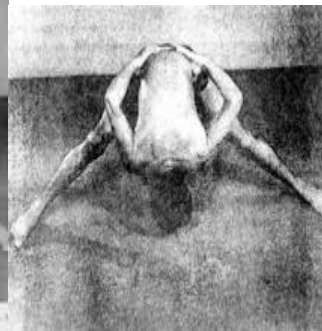
KEHUNI SHAKTI VIKASAKA FOR ELBOWS



MANIBANDHA SHAKTI VIKASAKA FOR WRISTS



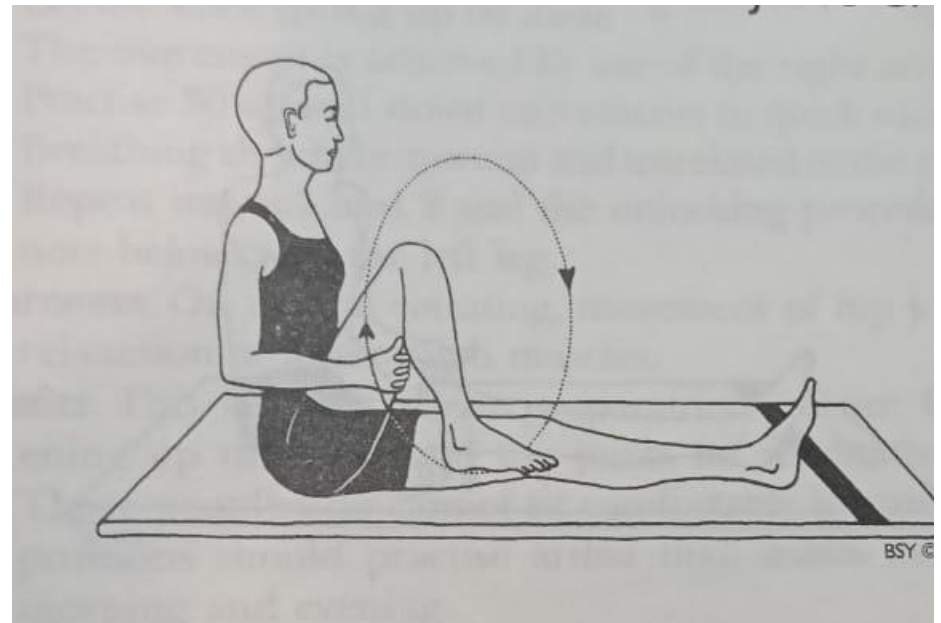
KATI SHAKTI VIKASAKA FOR WAIST / TRUNK



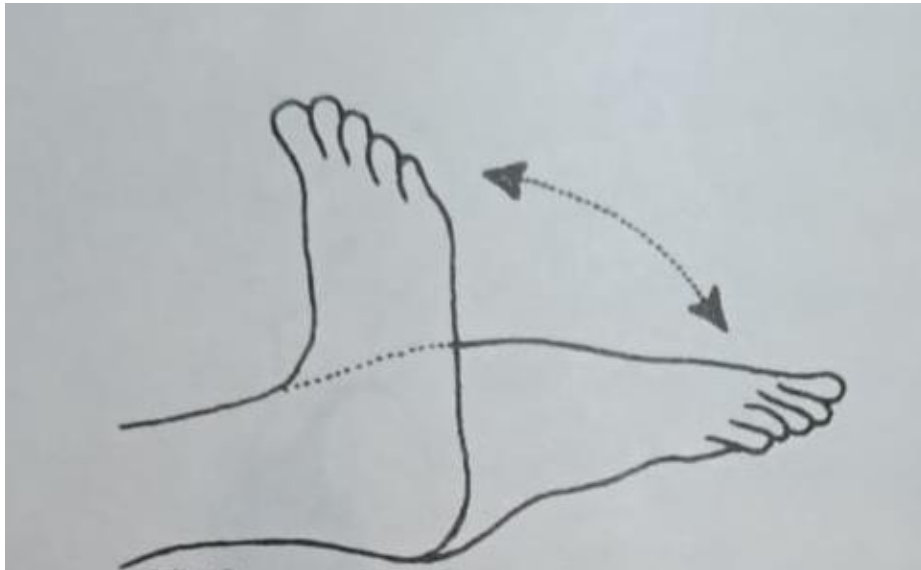
JANGHA SHAKTI VIKASAKA FOR HIPS



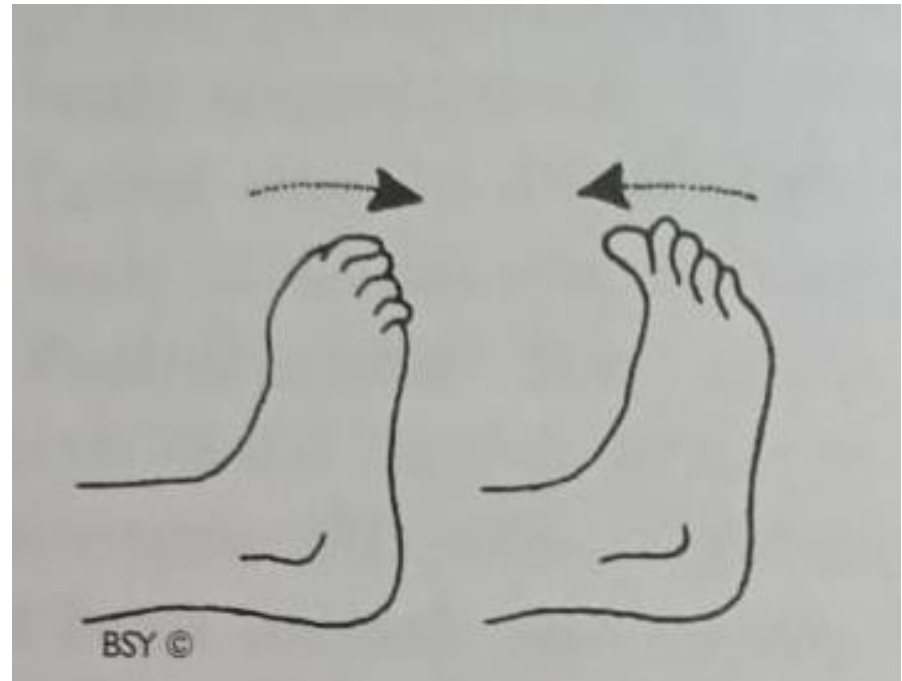
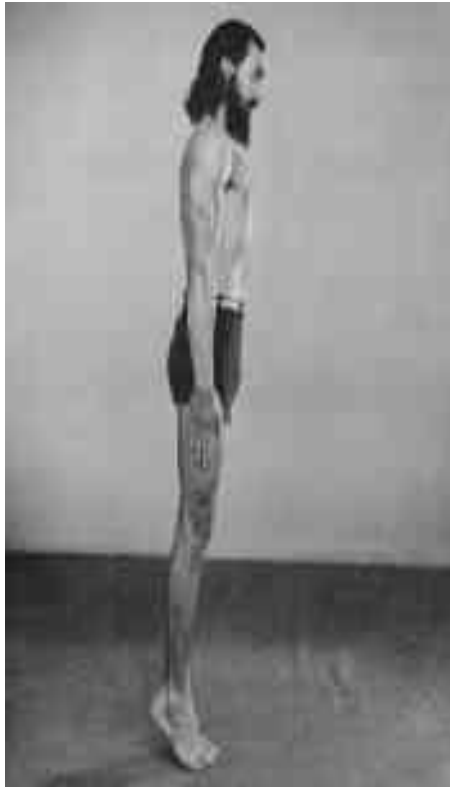
JANU SHAKTI VIKASAKA FOR KNEES



GOOLFA SHAKTI VIKASAKA FOR ANKLES



PADA ANGULI SHAKTI VIKASAKA FOR TOES



SARVANGA PUSHTI

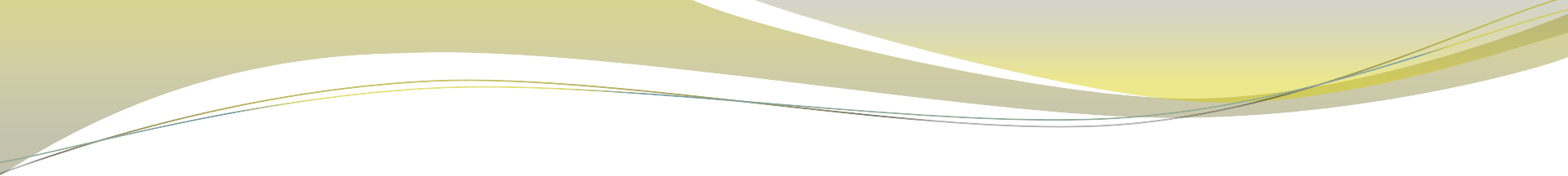
- With your feet as wide apart as possible, form fists with the thumbs tucked in
- Then with one wrist upon the other, bend towards the ankle of the right leg.
- Inhaling through the nose, raise the arms backward and forward describing a circle with the trunk and bring them down towards the left ankle.
- Repeat movement from left to right ankle
- The body becomes supple and strong; stiff backs are cured.



HRID GATI - ENGINE DAUD

- Run for 50 steps (small or spot) making piston movements of arms, hitting buttock with heel of the backward leg
- Sharp breaths will produce hissing sound of Engine.
- It re-vitalises the entire body. The chest expands the muscles of thighs and the calves are developed





IMPORTANCE OF BREATH

LECTURE BY: DR. ALKA M. BHIVANDKAR
20,21,22 August 2025

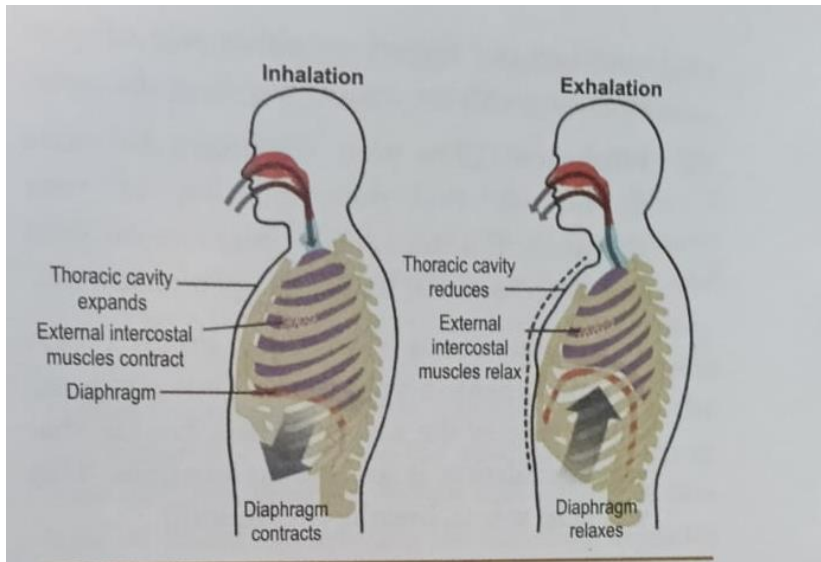
CONCEPT OF PRANA / PRANAYAMA

- Prana is life energy. It can be seen as the difference between a living body and dead body. It is like the unseen electricity which is a cause behind electrical appliances like fan, lights, etc.
- Pranayama is a systematic process by which we gain control and mastery over Prana
- प्राणस्य आयामः प्राणायामः - Mastery over Prana is Pranayama
- Breathing exercises are like a precursor to Pranayama to improve the lung capacity

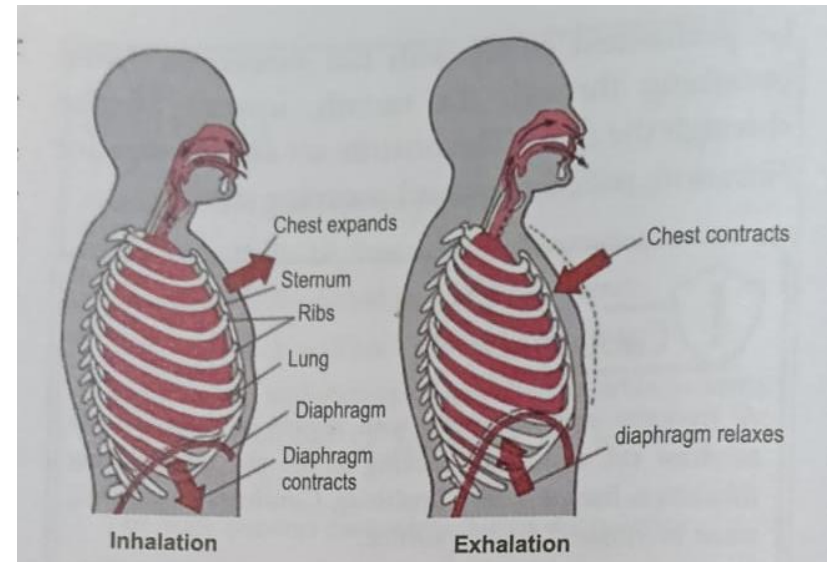
BREATHING PRACTICES

NAME OF PRACTICE
Hands in and out breathing
Hands up and down breathing
Sectional breathing
Abdominal (Diaphragmatic) breathing
Thoracic (Intercoastal muscles) breathing
Clavicular (Shoulder muscles) breathing
Full Yogic breathing

BREATHING PRACTICES



Abdominal breathing
(focus on abdomen)



Thoracic breathing
(focus on chest)

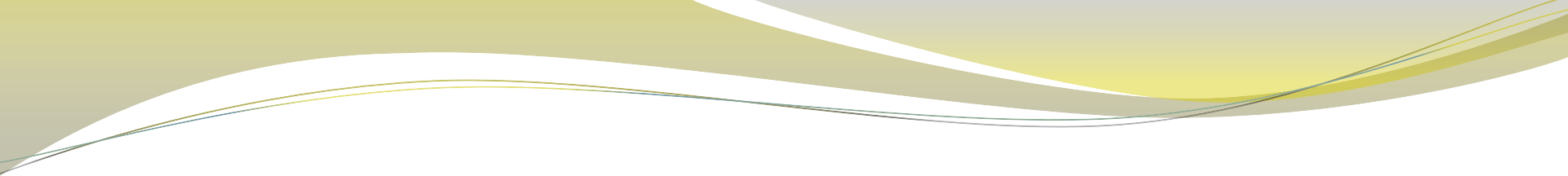
DID YOU KNOW?

**DEEP BREATHING IS ONE OF THE
BODY'S STRONGEST SELF-HEALING MECHANISMS'.**
- HARVARD



Short-term and long-term health benefits are due to changes in the body physiology that include lowered blood pressure, reduced heart rate, decreased release of stress hormones, stress relief, better balance between the gases in blood, enhanced physical and mental energy, and better immunity.

SOURCE: DOVEMED



DEVELOPING CONCENTRATION

BREATH - MIND CONNECTION

- Gross functional manifestation of Prana is breathing
- Subtle manifestation of Pranic energy is mind
- A strong relation exists between breathing and mind
- Therefore to control the mind which is a subtle manifestation of Prana one has to control breathing which is a gross functional manifestation of Prana.
- Thus breathing is an instrument to control Prana and in turn the mind
 - Mind - Very difficult to control
 - Breathing - Semi controllable
 - Prana Dharana - Fully develops concentration

BREATH AWARENESS – PRANA DHARANA

Prana Dharana - This is Fixation of the Mind on Breath

Three stages of **Prana Dharana** are

i. Prana Dharana – Prathama

By counting the breath –

One inhalation and one exhalation is 1 breath

ii. Prana Dharana – Dvitiya

Feeling the touch of the breath at the walls of the nostrils as cool air enters and warm air leaves the nose

iii. Prana Dharana – Tritiya

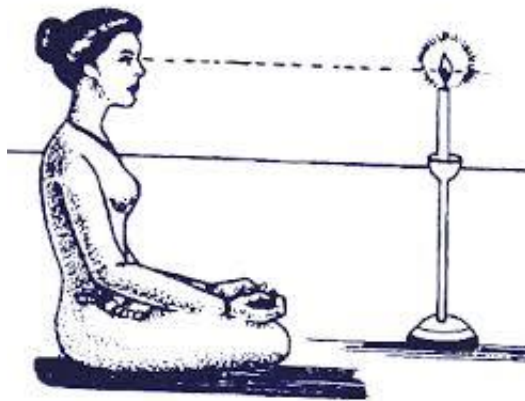
Feel the subtle thermal sensations at the soft palate as air enters the lungs during respiration

Prana Dharana is an easy and effective way of developing concentration

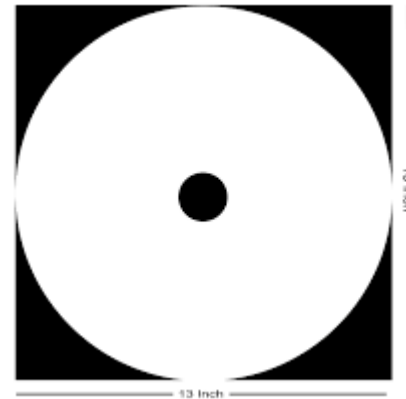
STEADY GAZING – TRATAKA

Trataka is found beneficial for improving :

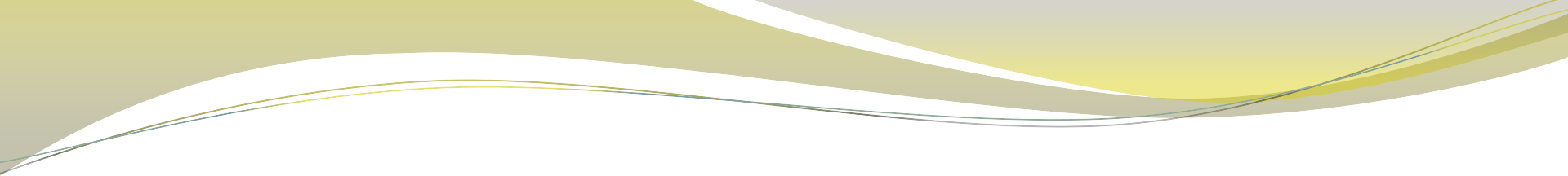
- cognitive performance
- heart rhythm
- emotional control
- mental relaxation
- eye health



Jyoti tratak



Dot tratak



YOGA FOR MIND - BODY WELLNESS

CONCEPT OF HEALTH

The Constitution of the World Health Organisation (WHO) sets out the principles of health

- Health is defined as a state of complete physical, mental and social well-being and not merely the absence of disease or infirmity.
- The enjoyment of the highest attainable standard of health is one of the fundamental rights of every human being without distinction of race, religion, political belief, economic or social condition.
- The health of all people is fundamental to the attainment of peace and security and is dependent on the fullest co-operation of individuals and States

WHAT IS WELLNESS ?

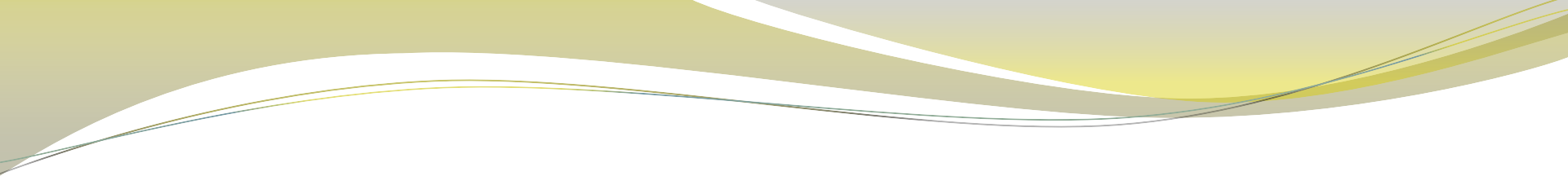
- Wellness can be defined with eight aspects: emotional, environmental, financial, intellectual, occupational, physical, social and spiritual
- Wellness is a state beyond absence of illness but rather aims to optimize well-being, a dynamic process of change and growth
- Wellness is an active process of becoming aware of and making choices toward a healthy and fulfilling life. Well-being directly affects our thoughts, emotions and actions
- Achievement of optimal wellness is essential to subdue stress, reduce the risk of illness and ensure positive interactions with others

WELLNESS & YOGA

- Mobility of Joints - Sukshma Vyayamas
- Muscular strength - Cultural Asanas
- Balance of Body - Balancing Asanas
- Flexibility in Body - Twisting Asanas
- Mental and emotional health – Pranayama, Mantras
- Holistic Wellness - Meditation practices

HEALTH AND WELLNESS





THANK YOU